

UAV Twin — Operator Outreach Kit

Templates, contacts, and follow-up cadence for Phase 2 conversations

Asick Jahir · with Claude (Anthropic)

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1. What we're actually asking for

Not a sale. Not a pilot. A **20-minute conversation to validate the positioning**. Specifically:

- Do you actually feel the pain we think you feel? (Excel records falling apart, batteries retired too early, motor bearing failures discovered only in flight.)
- What would you pay for a solution that ran on your own infrastructure instead of a per-vehicle SaaS subscription?
- Would you consider being a design partner — sharing anonymised flight logs in exchange for a free tier and direct input into the roadmap?

The tool exists, the twin works, the models trained. All we need now is one real operator's voice to steer Phase 4.

2. Email templates

Rewrite in your own voice. These are drafts, not scripts. Keep every send under 150 words. Attach nothing on the first email — link to the demo and the GitHub repo, that's the entire pitch.

Template A — Founder / CEO / CTO of a mid-size drone company

Best for: Agnishwar Jayaprakash (Garuda), Prem Kumar Vislawath (Marut), Mrinal Pai (Skylark), Vipul Singh (Aereo), Neel Mehta / Nihar Vartak (Asteria).

Subject line variants (pick one, A/B them if you send more than 5):

- Open-source battery RUL twin for [Company] – 20 min?
- Aeronautical engineer in Chennai – quick question about your fleet
- Built an open ArduPilot fleet-health twin – feedback?

Body:

Hi [First name],

I'm an aeronautical engineer in Chennai (M.Sc. propulsion, Politecnico di Milano) and I've been building an open-source digital twin for ArduPilot / PX4 multirotor fleets. It fuses OpenModelica physics with a trained XGBoost bearing-

wear classifier and a Gaussian-process battery-RUL predictor — all on your own infra, no SaaS lock-in.

Live demo (synthesised data, no clone needed): <https://moulanamore.github.io/uav-twin/>

Repo: <https://github.com/moulanamore/uav-twin>

I'm not trying to sell you anything — I'm looking for one real operator to validate whether the positioning holds. Specifically: is per-flight battery-life and bearing-wear prediction actually valuable to [Company]'s ops at fleet scale, or is a simpler Airdata-style dashboard enough?

Would you have 20 minutes in the next two weeks? Any time between 5pm and 7pm IST works on my side.

Thanks, Asick <https://github.com/moulanamore>

Template B — Head of ops / fleet manager / MRO lead

Best for: someone whose title has “operations”, “maintenance”, “fleet” in it, at Tier 2+ companies (Skylark, Aereo, Asteria).

Subject:

- Battery replacement cadence — quick question

Body:

Hi [First name],

I run into a lot of drone-operator posts asking how to track battery health without paying an Airdata subscription per flight. I've been building an open, self-hostable answer to that — a physics + ML twin that runs on any ArduPilot/PX4 fleet.

Two quick questions for you, if you have a minute:

1. How do you decide when to retire a battery today — cycle count, voltage sag, calendar, or the pilot's judgement?
2. What would change for [Company] if you had a per-battery RUL forecast with a 90% credible interval, updated every flight?

Live demo: <https://moulanamore.github.io/uav-twin/> Source: <https://github.com/moulanamore/uav-twin>

Happy to jump on a 15-minute call if either question is interesting.

Thanks, Asick (Chennai)

Template C — Technical DM on LinkedIn

Best for: LinkedIn cold outreach where the character limit and attention span are both shorter than email. Send from your own account, not from a page.

Hi [First name] — aeronautical engineer in Chennai here. Built an open-source ArduPilot/PX4 fleet twin (physics + XGBoost bearing wear + GP battery RUL).

Live demo: moulanamore.github.io/uav-twin. Would 20 minutes to validate the positioning be possible? Not selling — looking for a design partner to shape Phase 4.

If they engage, drop the repo link in the next message.

3. Contact list

Tier 1 first (agri-spray, high battery-cycling pain). Send no more than 3 outreach emails per day so you can respond thoughtfully to each reply.

Tier 1 — Agri-spray, high fleet count

Company	Person	Role	LinkedIn	Notes
Garuda Aerospace	Agnishwar Jayaprakash	Founder & CEO	linkedin.com/in/agnishwar-jayaprakash	Chennai-based (proximity advantage). 2,000+ agri-drones, 10L flight hours in past year. Highest priority.
Marut Drones	Prem Kumar Vislawath	Founder & CEO	Search LinkedIn for “Prem Kumar Vislawath Marut Drones”	Hyderabad. \$6.2M Series A. Multi-utility agri drones.

Tier 2 — Enterprise inspection, mapping, survey

Company	Person	Role	LinkedIn	Notes
Skylark Drones	Mrinal Pai	Co-Founder	linkedin.com/in/mrinalpai	Bangalore. Industrial inspection, mapping. ArduPilot-based custom builds likely.
Aereo (formerly Aarav Unmanned)	Vipul Singh	Co-Founder	Search LinkedIn “Vipul Singh Aereo”	Bangalore. Mining, urban planning, infrastructure. Large fleet.

Company	Person	Role	LinkedIn	Notes
Asteria Aerospace	Neel Mehta	Director & Co-Founder	linkedin.com/in/neelmehta-61006031	Bangalore. Reliance subsidiary. Defence-adjacent commercial services. Slower to close but bigger.
Asteria Aerospace	Nihar Vartak	Co-Founder	linkedin.com/in/nihavartak-b0663b9	Alternative contact if Neel doesn't respond.

Tier 3 — Adjacent (later)

Company	Focus	Notes
Redwing Labs	Autonomous medical delivery	Small fleet, tight margins — could care about battery life a lot.
DGCA-registered agri operators	Smaller local operators	5,000+ registered. Hit them via LinkedIn hashtag scraping later.

4. Follow-up cadence

Day 0: Send the email. Day 4: If no reply, one soft nudge — “reposting in case this got buried, worth 20 min?” Two-sentence max. Day 12: If still no reply, connect on LinkedIn with the template-C DM. Day 30: Move on. Don't chase further than that — it reads as desperation and closes the door for the next reason to reach out (Phase 4 launch, a paper, a press mention).

Track responses in a simple spreadsheet: one row per person, columns for date sent / date replied / meeting scheduled / notes. Don't over-engineer this; a Google Sheet with 20 rows is enough.

5. What to run in the 20-minute meeting

Once someone accepts, protect their time. Sample agenda:

Minute 0-2: You introduce yourself and the twin in 90 seconds. Show the live demo screen-shared. Don't over-explain — the visual does the work.

Minute 2-10: Ask, don't tell. Prepared questions:

1. “How does [Company] currently decide when a battery is retired?”

2. “When a motor fails in flight, what’s the first indicator you catch?”
3. “How are your maintenance records structured today — Excel, custom internal tool, a SaaS product?”
4. “If a per-vehicle RUL forecast with a 90% credible interval landed on the pilot’s tablet before every flight, would that change how you dispatch?”

Minute 10-15: Their questions about the twin. Be honest about limitations:

- Models trained on synthetic ALFA/NASA data — needs real-fleet retraining to generalise to their duty cycles
- The FMU physics is Modelica-generated but the parameters are literature defaults — bench-testing their motors would refine them
- Open source; no support SLA today

Minute 15-20: The one specific ask.

“If we agree the twin looks useful, would [Company] consider being a design partner for the next three months? Concretely: share anonymised log files from 20-30 flights in exchange for free tier access, direct input into which features we build next, and named credit in the project when we publish.”

If they say maybe: send a one-page design-partner memo within 24 hours. If they say no: ask what would make them say yes.

6. Parallel channels

Not every conversation starts with a cold email. Where each helps:

- **ArduPilot Discourse** (discuss.ardupilot.org) — post a short project introduction in the “Show and Tell” or “Ground Control Software” category. Operators lurk here.
- **DGCA drone stakeholder meets** — attend one if any are announced. Chennai / Bangalore see 2-3 a year.
- **LinkedIn posts** — one every 2 weeks with a specific technical finding from the twin (e.g., “here’s why we chose Matérn 5/2 for battery RUL instead of an LSTM”). Builds credibility without asking for anything.
- **Aerospace propulsion friends from Politecnico** — introduce the twin to any classmates now working in propulsion at Airbus / Leonardo / Marelli. Not customers, but potential validators of the physics.

7. What “success” looks like at each stage

- **Week 1 of outreach:** 10 emails sent, 2 opens (LinkedIn stalking confirms), 0 replies. This is normal. Keep going.
- **Week 3:** First real reply, either a “not now, but interesting” or a “sure, book a call”. Either is signal.
- **Week 6:** First 20-minute call held. Write up notes within 24 hours.
- **Week 8:** Second call held. Compare notes — is the same pain showing up across both?
- **Month 3:** One design-partner agreement in principle, even if informal. That unlocks Phase 4 data and validates every assumption in the market analysis.

If no design partner materialises by Month 6, revisit the positioning. Options at that point: pivot to a specific vertical (only agri-spray?), pivot to a specific persona (only maintenance managers?), or pivot to a specific business model (services / consulting instead of product).

This is a template. Track what actually works in your responses column and evolve the copy as evidence arrives. The rule of thumb: your third email will convert 3x better than your first.